



WPI

<https://www.wpi.edu/>
508-831-5000

Create a Personal Website at WPI

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Description

Instructions to create a homepage on the WPI Hostspace.

WPI students, faculty, and staff have the ability to create a website using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, hosted on the WPI server. This website space is called your "Userspace." Personal website can be viewed by navigating to <https://users.wpi.edu/~username> where username is your WPI username.

Content placed within a user's public_html directory can be served out by the WPI web server. Follow instructions below for accessing your userspace, adding content, and modifying the permissions to your site.

Departmental Sites & Faculty Profiles

Contact Marketing & Communications for creation/modifications.

Requirements

- The file name of your website homepage must be named `index.html`
- `index.html` must be located in your `public_html` folder
- All websites must follow WPI's Acceptable Use Policy

Note:

As of 11/20/2024, OpenID Connect (OIDC) is turned on and CAS for public_html has been retired. For more information about OIDC, please view Microsoft's [What is OIDC? article](#).

Folders

Folders added or modified to your userspace public_html folder are set to **0701**:

- User: **Read & Write & Execute**
- World: **Execute**

Files

Files added or modified to your userspace public_html folder are set to **0744**:

- User: **Read & Write & Execute**
- World: **Execute**

Updating Your Userspace

There are currently two general ways to manage the files in your userspace:

1. Edit files on your local machine from the **mapped drive**
2. Edit files in Terminal while **sshed to the Linux Cluster**

Follow additional guidance below on mapping your drive, editing files, or accessing your public_html folder from the Linux Terminal Cluster.

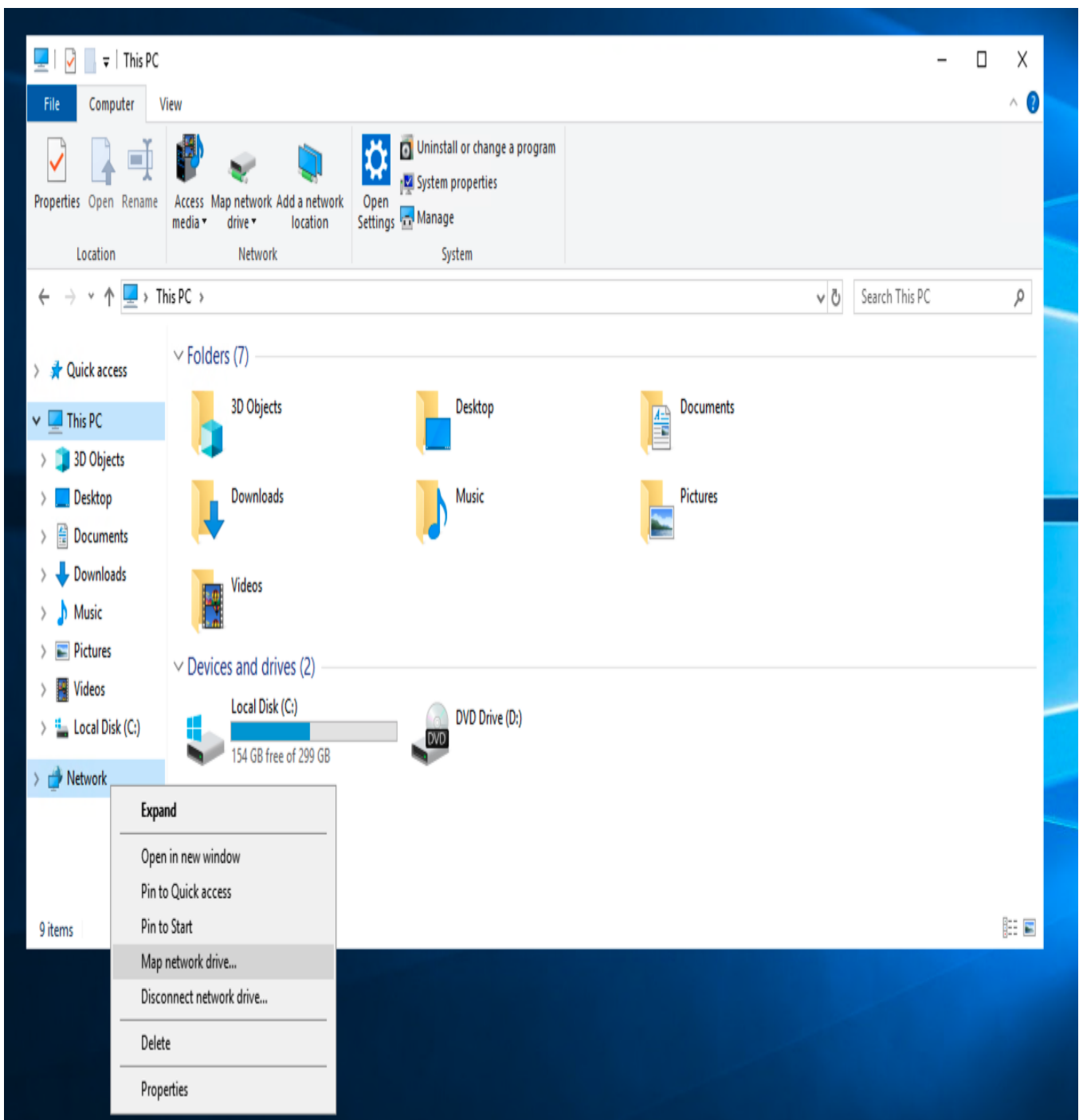
▼ Map Your User Drive

To get started, create your files and directories in your public_html folder by mapping:

- Windows: \\users.wpi.edu\personalweb\public_html
- Mac OSX / Linux: smb://users.wpi.edu/personalweb/public_html

Windows Drive Mapping

- Open **File Explorer**
- Right-Click over **Network** and select **Map network drive...**

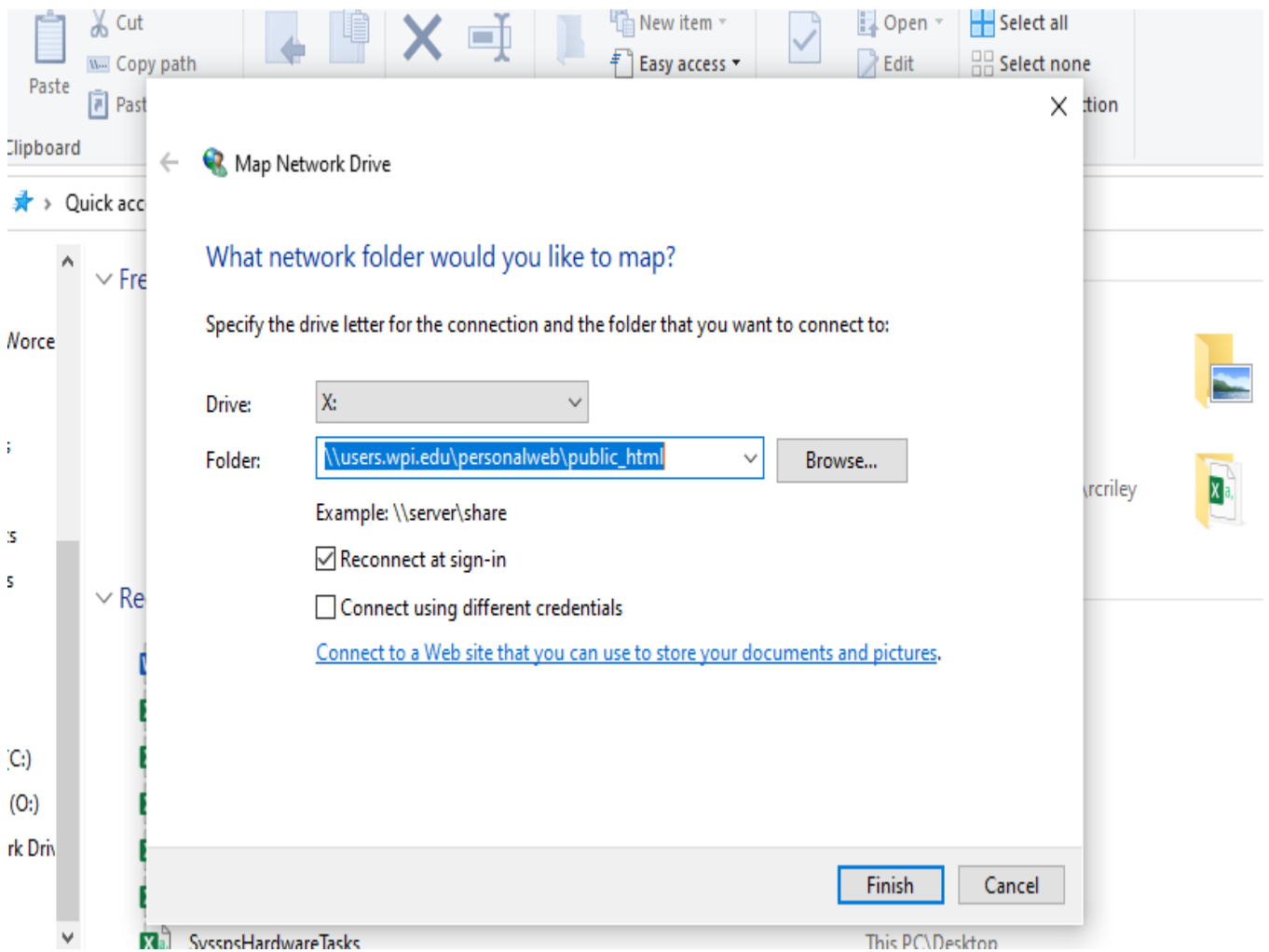


File Explorer window with the pop-up displaying option when right-clicking on "Network". "Map network drive..." is highlighted.

If you have a preferred letter to map the drive to, select the **Drive** from the dropdown.
Input the following in **Folder**: \\users.wpi.edu\personalweb\public_html

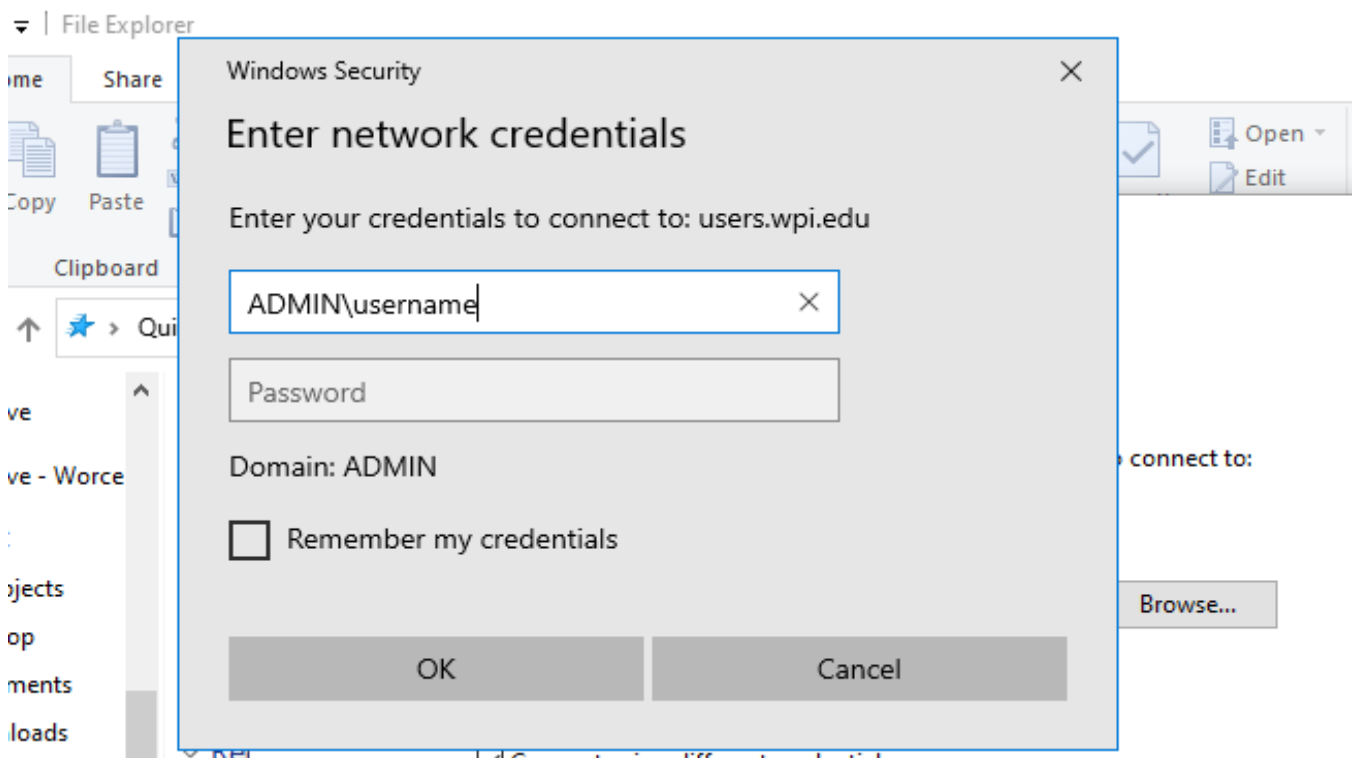
Working on a Group Page?

If you are working site, you must check **Connect using different credentials**. Input the account credentials for the group when connecting.



Map Network Drive window with \\users.edu\personalweb\public_html mapped to the X: drive.

If on a personal device, make sure you are connecting to the ADMIN domain with your WPI Username and Password:



Input WPI credentials with admin\wpiusername in username field and your WPI password.

MacOS Drive Mapping

Linux Users

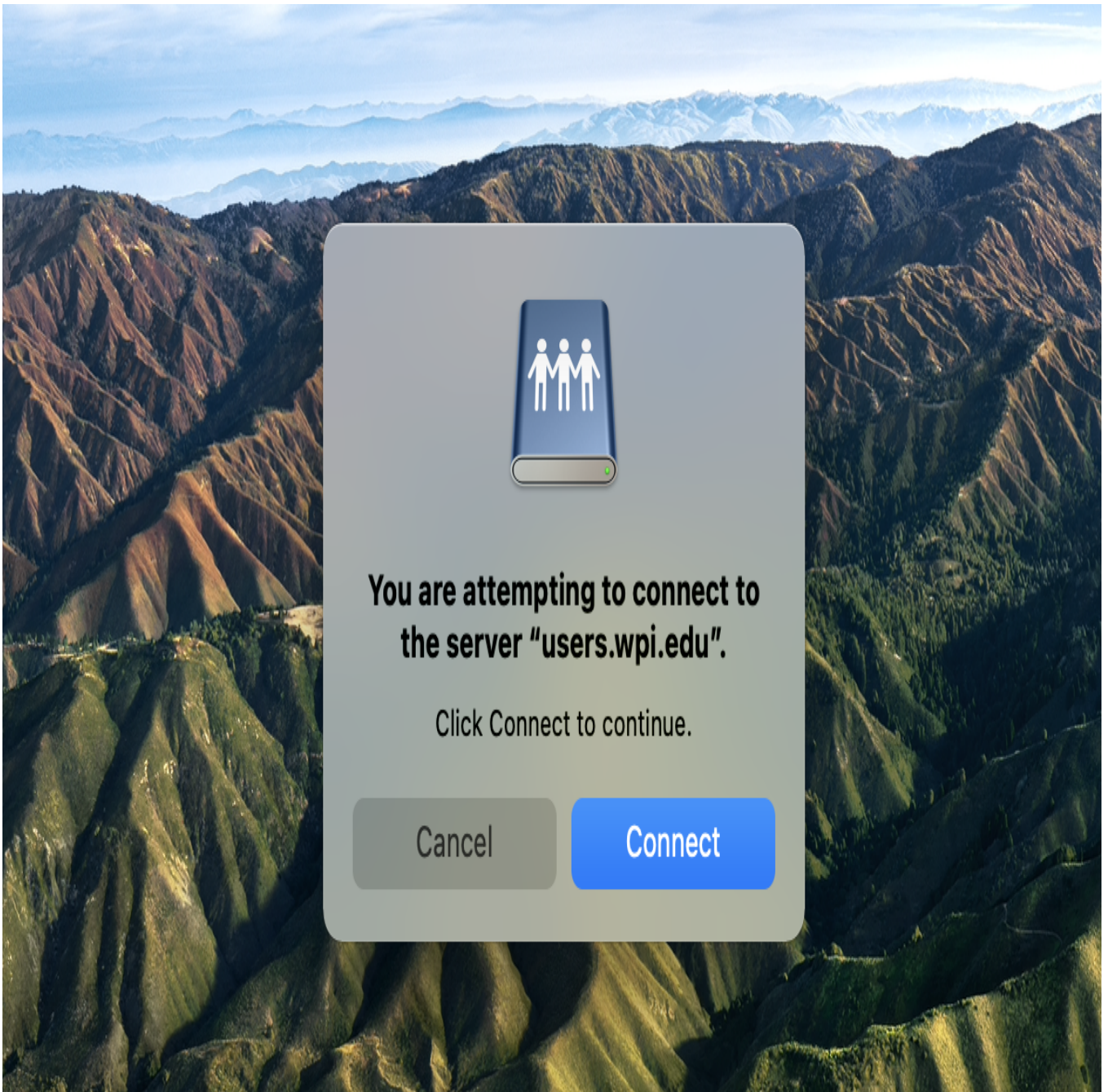
Linux users will have a similar experience using their preferred method for accessing network drives.

- From the Finder **Application**, go to **Go > Connect to Server** (or use Command + k)
- Input the following server: `smb://users.wpi.edu/personalweb/public_html`



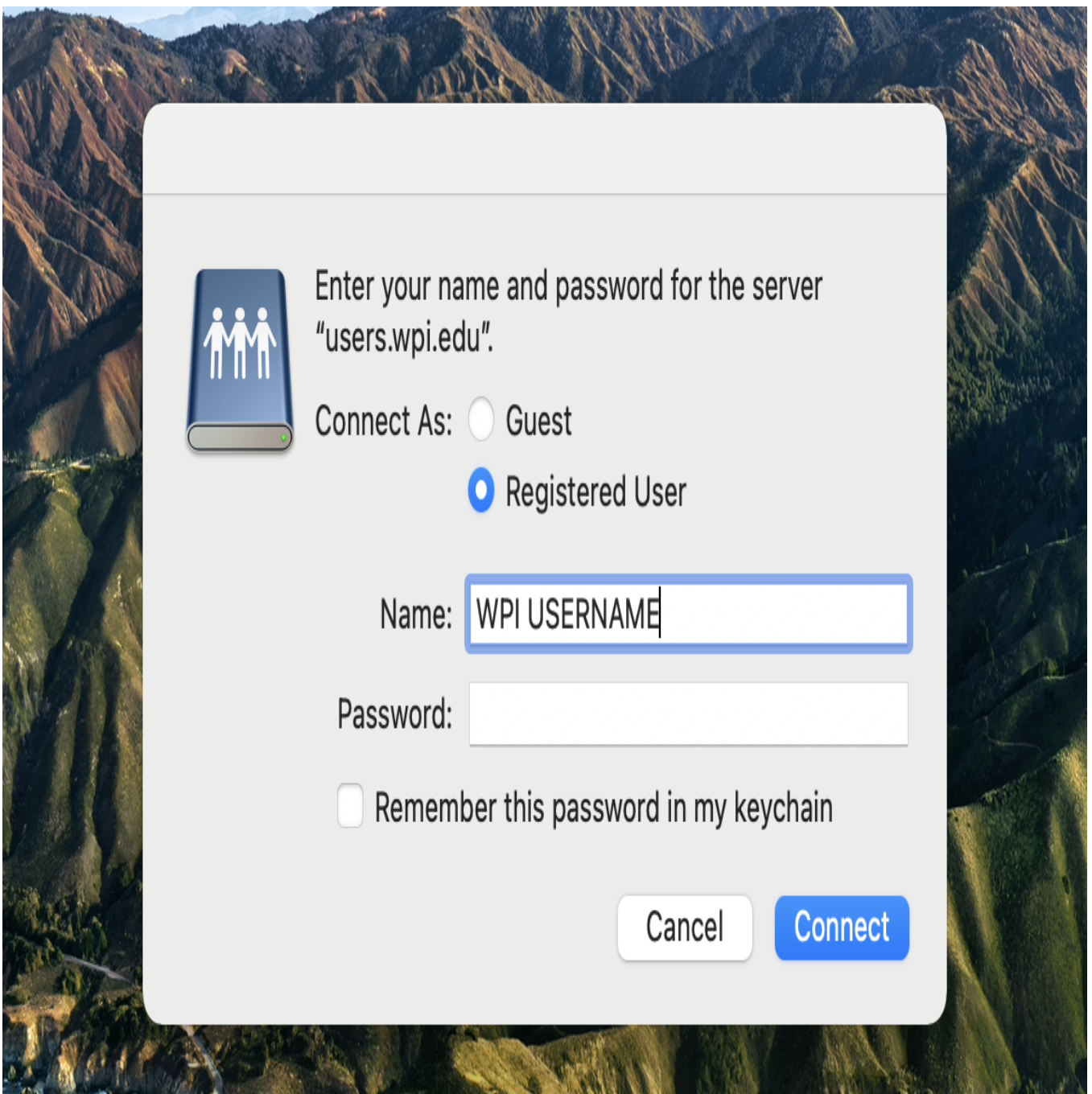
Connect to Server window with server information input: `smb://users.wpi.edu/personalweb/public_html`

Press **Connect** on the pop-up



"You are attempting to connect to the server "users.wpi.edu"" pop-up screen.

Input the credentials for the user space you wish to access.



MacOS Credential screen - Enter your WPI username / password as a Registered User to connect to the server.

▼ Add Files with Drag/Drop on Mapped Drives

Your mapped **public_html** folder is where you will keep all content you wish to display on your website. The content of your website's homepage must be in an HTML file called: `index.html`

Use a text editor (Notepad, TextEdit, etc.), or source code editor (VS Code, Atom, etc.), to create HTML, CSS, and JavaScript files to save within your `public_html` directory.

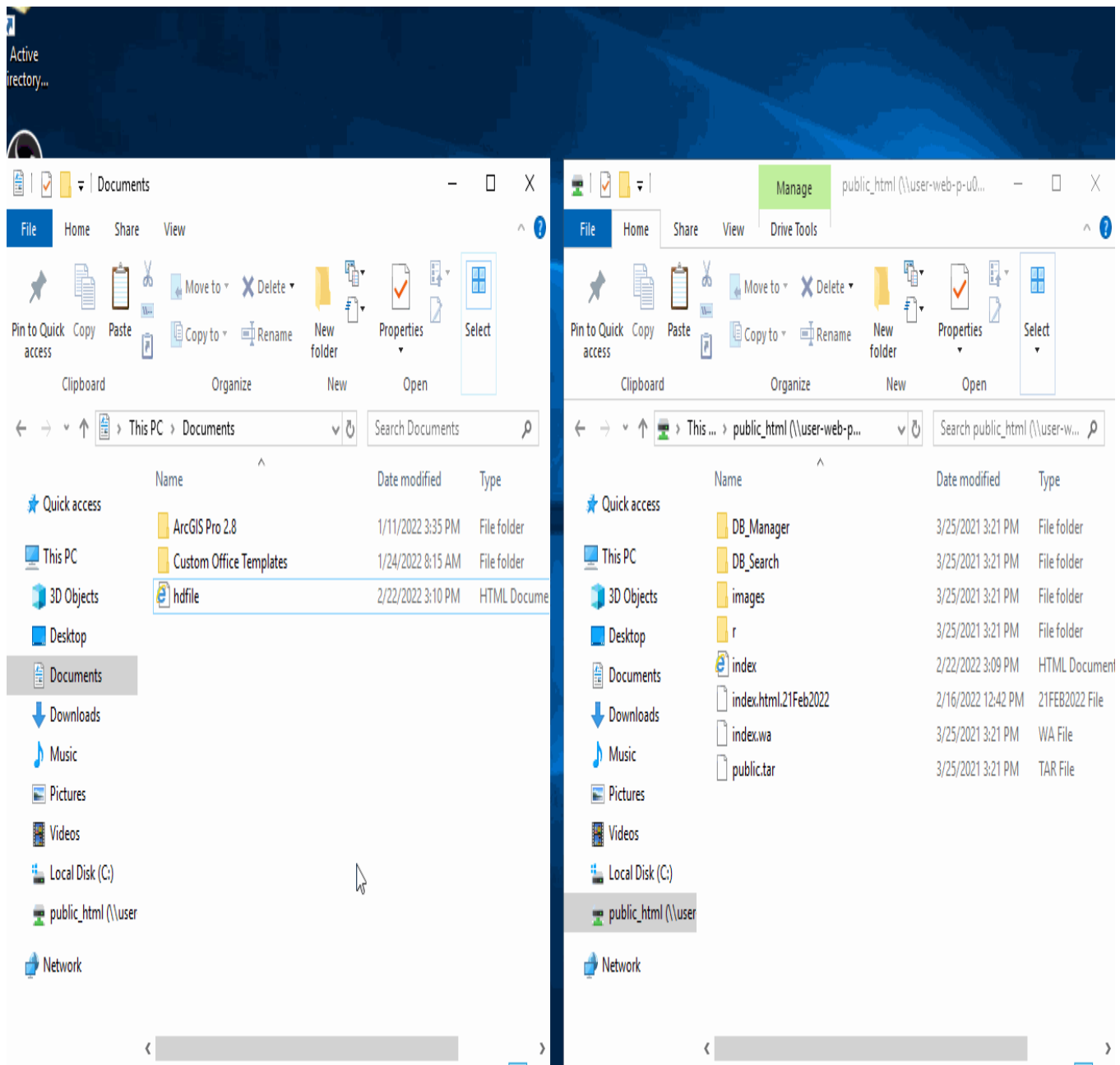
You can add to your `public_html` folder and/or edit your personal web space by:

- Drag and drop files from the local hard drive into the `public_html` folder
- Using WPI's Gitlab server for source control
 - See Related Article: **Use Gitlab To Update Personal Userspace Website**

Drag and Drop

Files stored locally, on a different share, or on an external hard drive (flash drive) can be dragged from their original storage location into the mapped network drive through File Explorer (Windows) or Finder (MacOS).

Windows

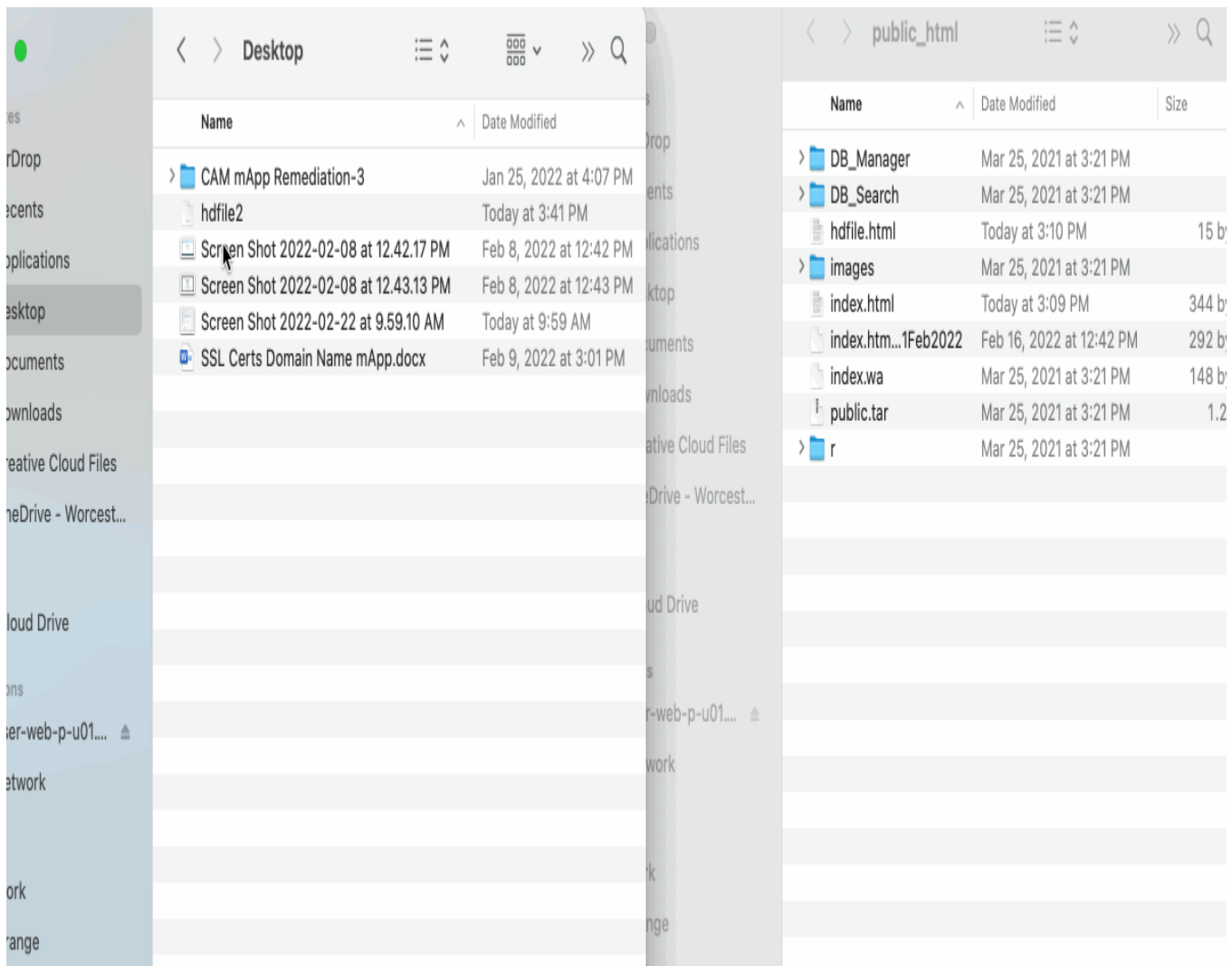


Drag hdfile.html from local Documents folder to \\users.wpi.edu\personalweb\public_html

Replace or Skip Files Pop-Up

Select **Replace the file in this destination**. We recognize the file may not exist or have existed in the directory - IT is looking for a solution to this pop-up.

MacOS



Drag hdfile2.html from local Desktop folder to \\users.wpi.edu\personalweb\public_html

▼ Editing Files from the Mapped Drive

In order to edit existing files in the mapped public_html folder, **users must launch the application from the mounted drive**. The best way to do that is to:

1. **Right-Click** on the file
2. Select **Open With**
3. Choose the application

Recommended Applications for Specific File Types

Your public_html folder may contain different types of files. The following is a general guide to follow

File Type	Application Suggestion
.txt	Text Editor or Source Code Editor
.html	Source Code Editor

A few free / open-source editors include:

- **Atom**: Free, open-source Source Code Editor
- **CodeRunner**: Free programming editor (compose and test code)
- **VS Code**: Free Code Editor (debugging, task running, and version control)

Using Source Code Editors

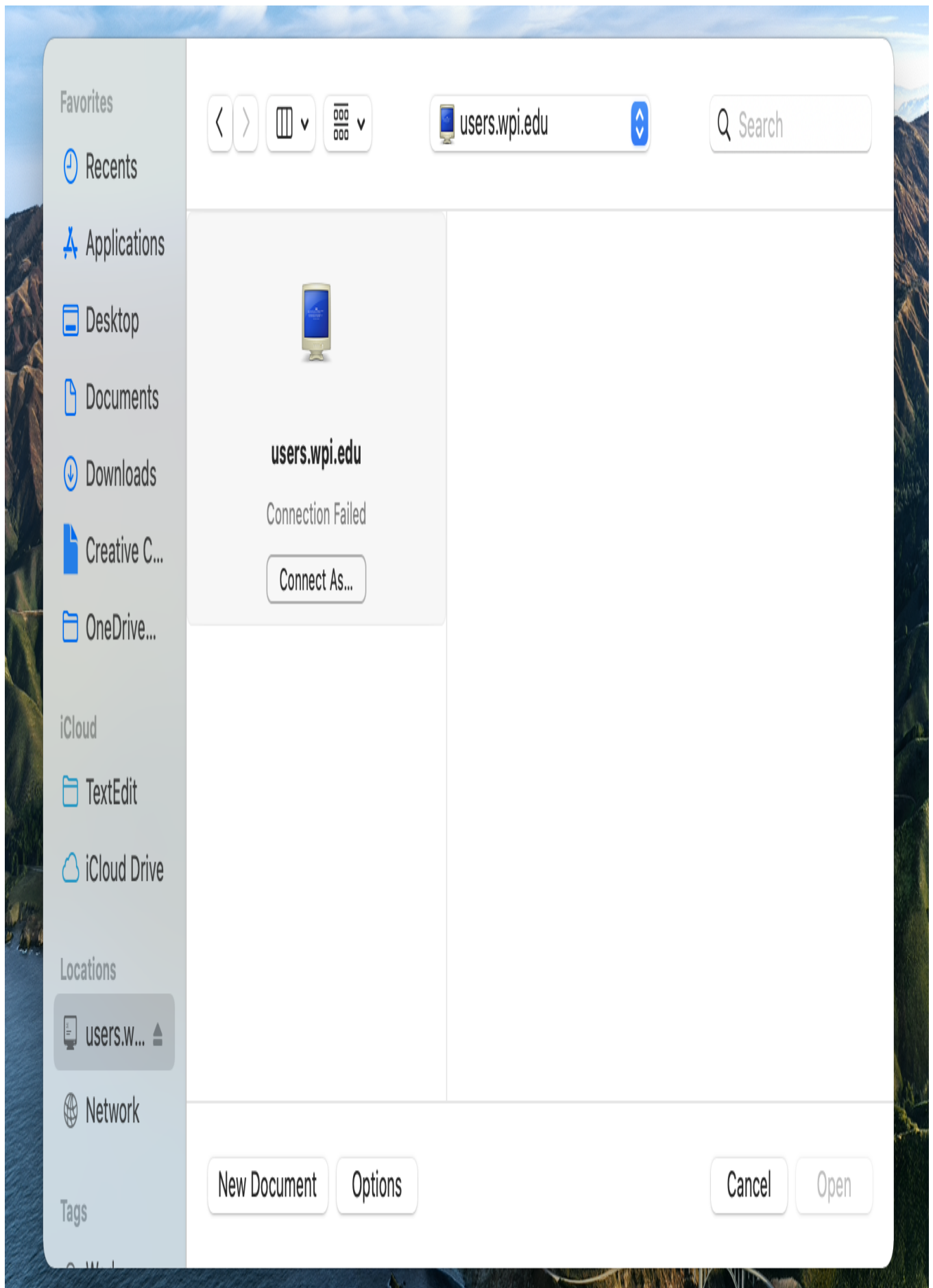
•

Editing with Text Editors

While this section of the content demos with TextEdit, the content applies to all general Text Editor applications.

Again, in order to edit files in any application, but in this case, TextEdit on MacOS, **users must launch the file from the mounted network drive.**

Users cannot access the files from the locations within the Open Document screen in TextEdit. The following error displays:



Connection Failed error when attempting to access users.wpi.edu in the Locations section of the TextEdit Open document window.

Open .txt Files in TextEdit

Use TextEdit for .txt Files Only

TextEdit is unable to modify .html files. Use this process for .txt files only.

To access your files and make edits in TextEdit:

1. Open your mapped network drive
2. Right-click on the file you wish to edit
3. Select **Open With** and choose **TextEdit**

Favorites

AirDrop

Recents

Applications

Desktop

Documents

Downloads

Creative Cloud Files

OneDrive - Worcest...

iCloud

iCloud Drive

Locations

user-web-p-u01....

Network

< > public_html

Recents

public_html

Name

Date Modified

Size

Kind

TrainingFinal2.1.html

Mar 22, 2021 at 10:04 AM

6.4 MB

HTML text

> testing

Mar 22, 2021 at 10:04 AM

--

Folder

> test2

Feb 11, 2021 at 11:14 AM

--

Folder

Scav Hunt.tws

Mar 22, 2021 at 10:04 AM

5 KB

Document

PreNSOTraining.html

Mar 22, 2021 at 10:04 AM

903 KB

HTML text

pens.jpeg

Mar 22, 2021 at 10:04 AM

2.8 MB

JPEG image

markup.html

Mar 22, 2021 at 10:04 AM

884 bytes

HTML text

Lincoln.html

Mar 22, 2021 at 10:04 AM

172 bytes

HTML text

index.html

Today at 9:30 AM

2 KB

HTML text

IMG

Mar 22, 2021 at 10:04 AM

4.9 MB

MPEG-4 movie

> files

--

Folder

Doc

Zero bytes

HTML text

Boo

7 KB

Document

Open

Open With >

Move to Trash

Get Info

Rename

Compress "index.html"

Duplicate

Make Alias

Quick Look

Conv

Google Chrome (default)

Microsoft Excel

Microsoft Word

Notes

Safari

TextEdit

Visual Studio

Visual Studio Code 2

App Store...

13 of {total - pages}

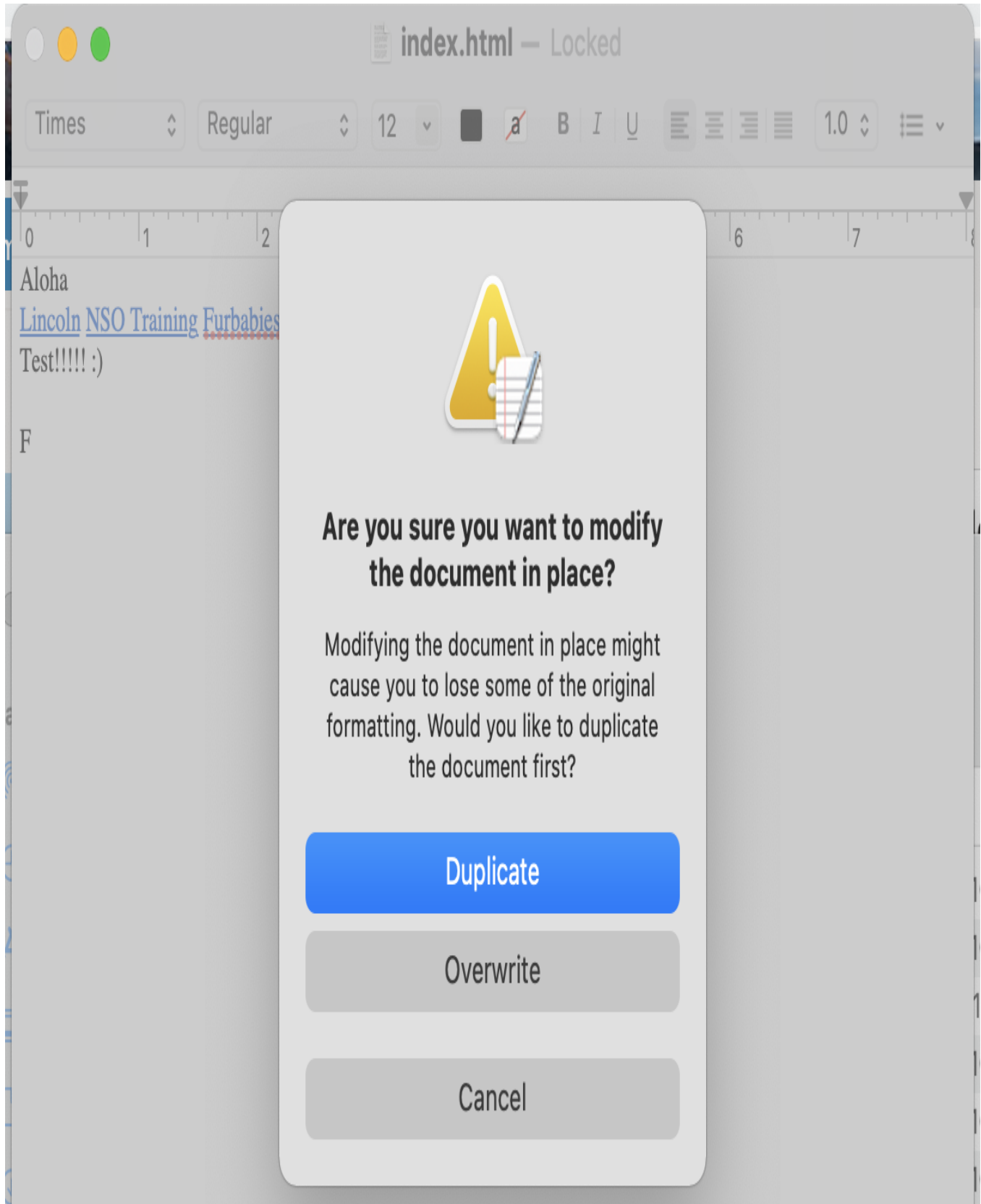
Saving Your Work in TextEdit

Overwrite on Save

When saving your work, you will be prompted with the following window:

Are you sure you want to modify the document in place? Modifying the document in place may cause you to lose some of the original formatting. Would you like to duplicate the document first?

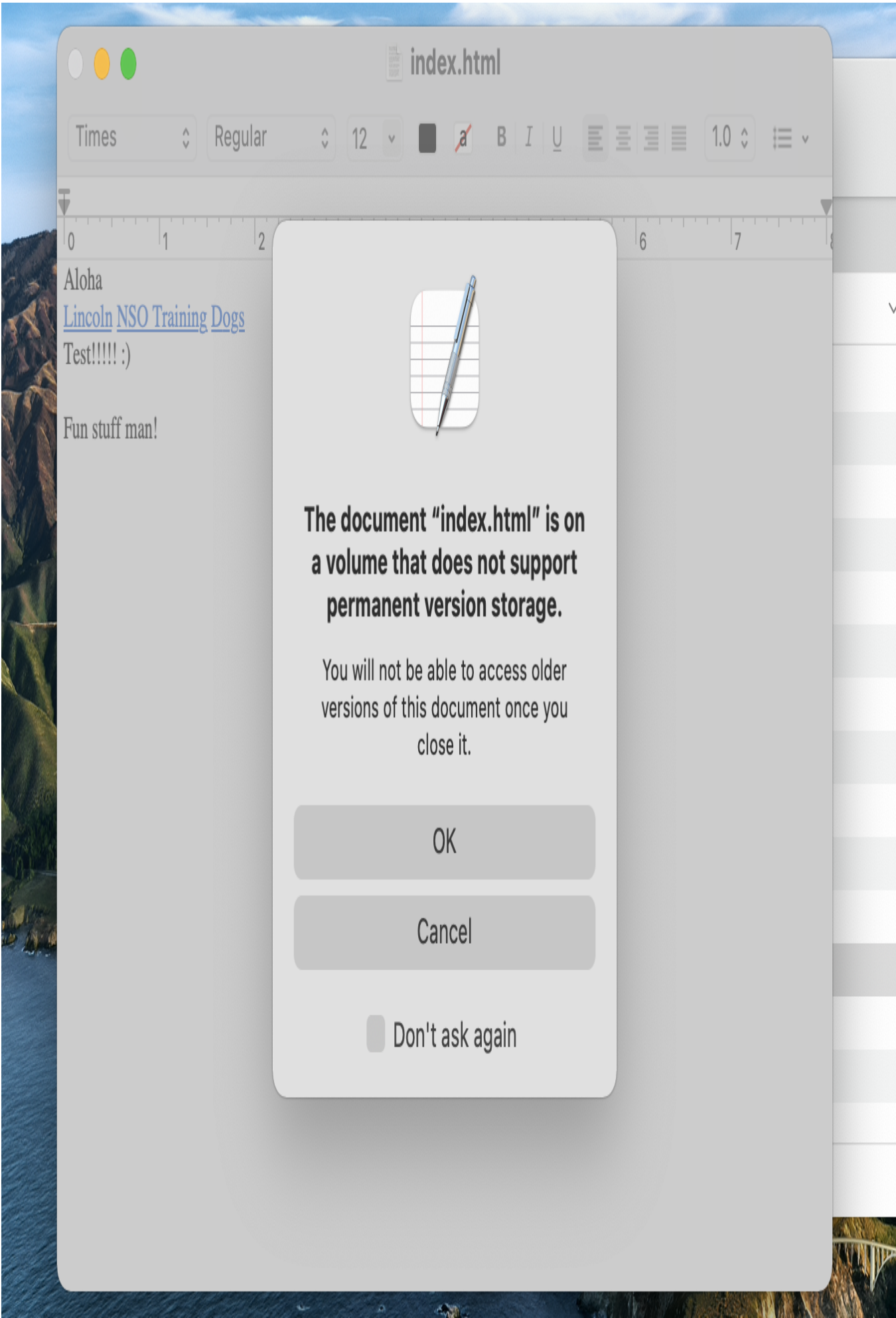
Choose the option to **OVERWRITE** the file.



Window prompt: Are you sure you want to modify the document in place? Modifying the document in place may cause you to lose some of the original formatting. Would you like to duplicate the document first?

No Versioning with TextEdit

Please note, the public_html folder on the isilon server does not support versioning. When attempting to save and close files, you will be prompted with the following:



▼ Edit Files Through ssh Terminal on Linux Cluster

Users can add, remove, or edit their documents in their `public_html` folder through an ssh session on the Linux Terminal Cluster (`linux.wpi.edu`).

From your terminal application (GitBash on Windows, or you can use PuTTY), ssh to `linux.wpi.edu`.

List of Commands

```
gio mount smb://users.wpi.edu/personalweb
gio info smb://users.wpi.edu/personalweb
cd /run/user/WPI_ID_NUMBER/gvfs/smb-share:server=users.wpi.edu,share=personalweb
```

*Where WPI ID NUMBER is your specific WPI ID Number.

Mount the `public_html` Drive

Run the following commands:

Command 1:

```
gio mount smb://users.wpi.edu/personalweb
```

When prompted, input:

- User [username]: Your WPI username
- Domain [SAMBA]: ADMIN
- Password: Your WPI Password

```
[~bash-4.4$ gio mount smb://users.wpi.edu/personalweb
Password required for share personalweb on users.wpi.edu
User [REDACTED]: [REDACTED]
Domain [SAMBA]: ADMIN
Password:
```

Terminal window with mount command and prompts for user input.

Command 2:

```
gio info smb://users.wpi.edu/personalweb
```

```

-bash-4.4$ gio info smb://users.wpi.edu/personalweb
display name: personalweb on users.wpi.edu
edit name: /
name: /
type: directory
size: 0
uri: smb://users.wpi.edu/personalweb/
attributes:
  standard::type: 2
  standard::name: /
  standard::display-name: personalweb on users.wpi.edu
  standard::edit-name: /
  standard::icon: folder-remote
  standard::content-type: inode/directory
  standard::size: 0
  standard::allocated-size: 0
  standard::symbolic-icon: folder-remote-symbolic
  etag::value: 1645532237
  id::filesystem: smb-share:server=users.wpi.edu,share=personalweb
  access::can-trash: FALSE
  time::modified: 1645532237
  time::modified-_usec: 863286
  time::access: 1645532237
  time::access-_usec: 863286
  time::changed: 1645532237
  time::changed-_usec: 863286
  unix::device: 2478631581
  unix::inode: 4766855054

```

Terminal window with info command and results of command input.

Command 3:

You must input your WPI ID Number before pressing Return:

```
cd /run/user/WPI_ID_NUMBER/gvfs/smb-share:server=users.wpi.edu,share=personalweb
```

```

-bash-4.4$ cd /run/user/746305649/gvfs/smb-share:server=users.wpi.edu,share=personalweb
-bash-4.4$ ls
public_html

```

Terminal window with run command and subsequent ls command to display the public_html folder.

Follow Along!

▼ Migrate Site Contents to External Host

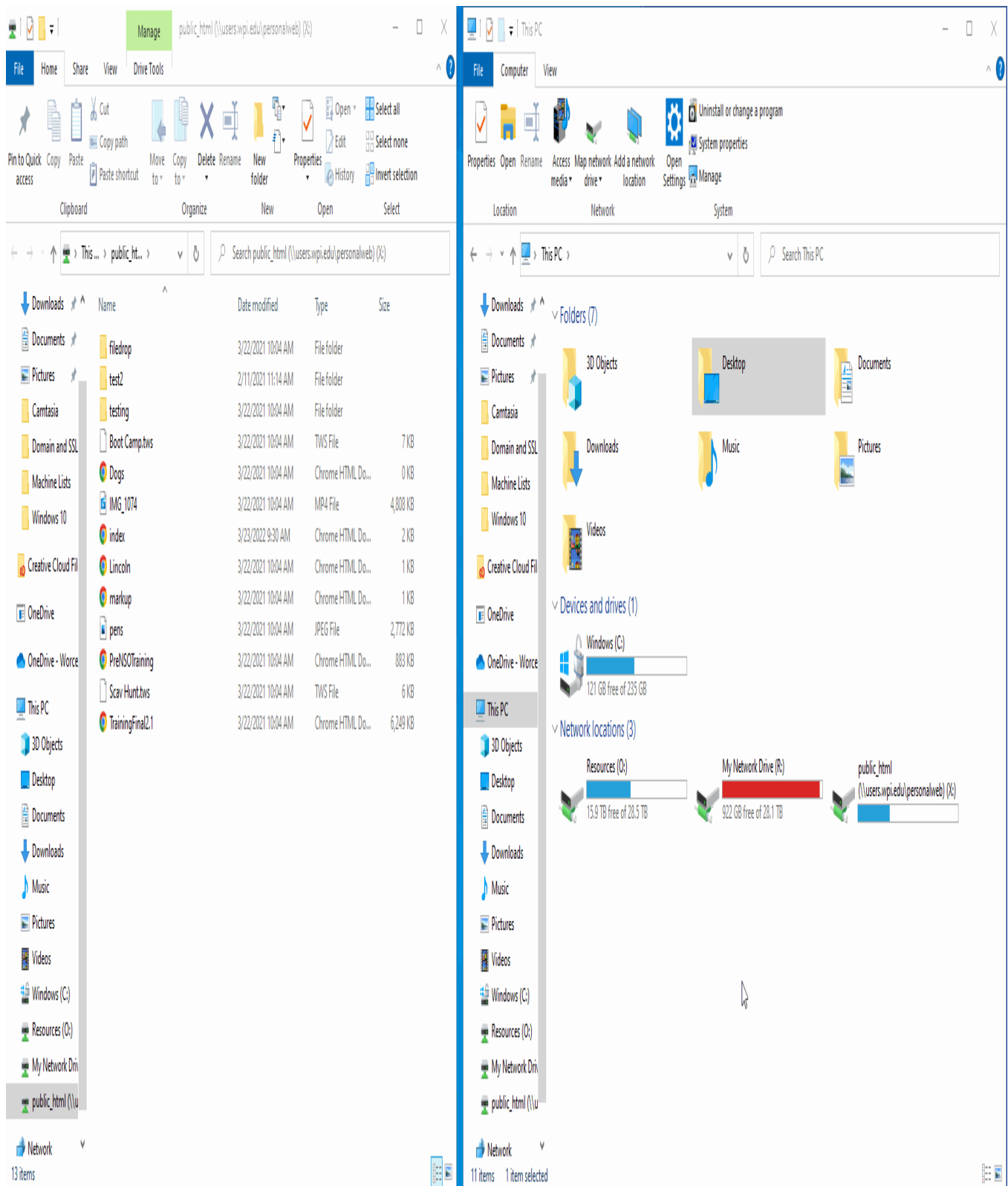
Users that leave WPI will not have their site hosted on the WPI servers after their account is disabled. Users must migrate their site contents to an external host prior to departure.

Drag / Drop to External USB or Personal Machine

Windows

1. In one **File Explorer** window, map your user drive
2. Open another **File Explorer** window
3. Create a folder called **My Website** on your local machine (My Documents folder for example)
4. Highlight all contents of your `public_html` folder
5. Drag the contents to the newly created folder on the local machine

You can move that folder to an external drive, USB, or cloud location.



Process for dragging and dropping from public_html folder to the local machine

MacOS

1. In one **Finder** window, map your user drive
2. Open another **Finder** window
3. Create a folder called **My Website** somewhere on your local machine (Documents folder for example)
4. Highlight all contents of your **public_html** folder
5. Drag the contents to the newly created folder on the local machine

You can move that folder to an external drive, USB, or cloud location.

Related Links

- [View Acceptable Use Policy.](#)

- [View Faculty Profile Instructions](#)

Resolution

Internal Memo